Unit 2: Climate Change

Reading: Climate change

Lesson 2-1
Book pages 13-15

💡 **Big idea:** **Climate change** is a change or increase in average global **temperatures**. Human activity releases **greenhouse gases** that trap the sun's heat, causing **heat waves, droughts, floods** and rising **sea levels**. Fighting it is **everyone's responsibility**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Understand the meaning of climate change
- Match paragraphs with subheadings
- Work out the meaning of new words from context
- Discuss our responsibility to stop climate change

📖 Key words

climate المناخ	**global warming** الاحتباس الحراري	**greenhouse gases** الغازات الدفيئة	**fossil fuels** الوقود الأحفوري
atmosphere الغلاف الجوي	**drought** جفاف	**flood** فيضان	**ice caps** القمم الجليدية
carbon footprint البصمة الكربونية	**release** يُطلق		

What is climate change?

- Climate = the weather in one place over a long period
- **Global warming** = increase in temperatures on Earth
- It affects every country in the world

Causes

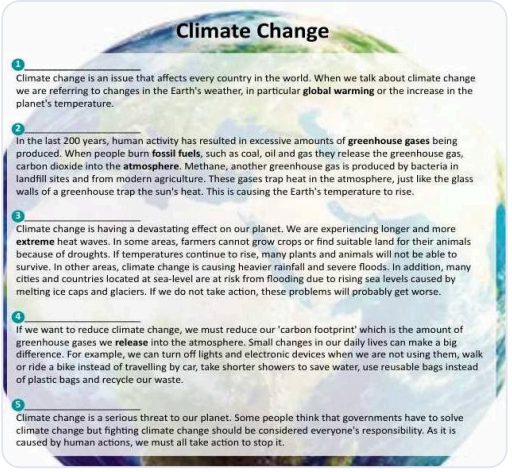
- Burning **fossil fuels** (coal, oil, gas) releases carbon dioxide
- Bacteria in landfill and farming produce **methane**
- Greenhouse gases trap the sun's heat like the glass walls of a **greenhouse**

Effects

- Longer and more **extreme heat waves**
- Farmers lose crops because of **droughts**
- Plants and animals may not survive
- Coastal cities at risk of **flooding** as ice caps and glaciers melt

What can we do?

- Reduce our **carbon footprint**
- Turn off lights and devices
- Walk or ride a bike instead of using the car
- Use reusable bags and recycle our waste



Climate Change

1 _____

Climate change is an issue that affects every country in the world. When we talk about climate change we are referring to changes in the Earth's weather, in particular **global warming** or the increase in the planet's temperature.

2 _____

In the last 200 years, human activity has resulted in excessive amounts of **greenhouse gases** being produced. When people burn **fossil fuels**, such as coal, oil and gas they release the greenhouse gas, carbon dioxide into the **atmosphere**. Methane, another greenhouse gas is produced by bacteria in landfill sites and from modern agriculture. These gases trap heat in the atmosphere, just like the glass walls of a greenhouse trap the sun's heat. This is causing the Earth's temperature to rise.

3 _____

Climate change is having a devastating effect on our planet. We are experiencing longer and more **extreme** heat waves. In some areas, farmers cannot grow crops or find suitable land for their animals because of droughts. If temperatures continue to rise, many plants and animals will not be able to survive. In other areas, climate change is causing heavier rainfall and severe floods. In addition, many cities and countries located at sea-level are at risk from flooding due to rising sea levels caused by melting ice caps and glaciers. If we do not take action, these problems will probably get worse.

4 _____

If we want to reduce climate change, we must reduce our 'carbon footprint' which is the amount of greenhouse gases we **release** into the atmosphere. Small changes in our daily lives can make a big difference. For example, we can turn off lights and electronic devices when we are not using them, walk or ride a bike instead of travelling by car, take shorter showers to save water, use reusable bags instead of plastic bags and recycle our waste.

5 _____

Climate change is a serious threat to our planet. Some people think that governments have to solve climate change but fighting climate change should be considered everyone's responsibility. As it is caused by human actions, we must all take action to stop it.

The reading text: Climate Change

✏️ Examples

Work out from context: "These gases trap the sun's heat." What does trap mean?

Answer: to keep something inside so it cannot escape

Which subheading: "If we want to reduce climate change, we must reduce our carbon footprint"?

Answer: How can we stop climate change?

What does the greenhouse metaphor compare greenhouse gases to?

Answer: the glass walls of a greenhouse

⭐ Remember

- To guess a new word, look at the sentence before and after it
- Learn word families: climate, global warming, greenhouse

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ climate means the weather today ✓ climate is the weather over a long period
- ✗ fossil fuels are renewable ✓ fossil fuels will run out

🧩 **Activity:** Write three things your family can do to reduce your carbon footprint

✅ Check yourself

1. Name a greenhouse gas
2. Name a fossil fuel
3. What is a carbon footprint?

Answers: (1) carbon dioxide or methane ، (2) coal, oil or gas ، (3) the amount of greenhouse gases we release